BioTransport AI - Funding & Data Tracker

2026-09-16 · @Someone

Tracking external funding and training-data sources for the diabetes, anemia, glaucoma, and cancer-imaging work, plus open decisions for Dr. Penkova and Andy. Full source reviews and technical notes live in the **Research Notes & Sources** tab.

Snapshot

- **Fix Glaucoma Chatbot:** currently bugged -> 2 of 2 test questions ("How do I put in eyedrops?", "Can I go swimming?") returned "Something went wrong while generating a response." See Research Notes.
- **Nearest real funding deadline:** NIH NEI R21 (PAR-25-357), due **Oct 16, 2026**
  - about a month out, existing-data analysis only.
- **Fastest data to start with, no funding needed:** AI-READI (diabetes) and CP-AnemiC (anemia) are both accessible today at no cost.

Funding tracker

Source	Condition(s)	Amount	Deadline	Status	Notes
NIH NEI R21 – PAR-25-357	Glaucoma / retinal (secondary data analysis)	$275k / 2yr	**Oct 16, 2026**	Possible, target this cycle	Existing-data analysis only; pairs with AI-READI/EyePACS. NEI contacts: Donald Everett, Jimmy Le, Azadeh Shoaibi
BrightFocus National Glaucoma Research	Glaucoma	$150k / 2yr	Sep 24, 2026	Not now	8-day turnaround unrealistic from a cold start; target the FY28 cycle (opens ~Jun 2027)
Shaffer Grant	Glaucoma	$60k / 1yr	Closed (was Jul 15, 2026)	Not now	Reopens ~Jun–Jul 2027; PI needs a graduate degree

Source	Condition(s)	Amount	Deadline	Status	Notes
Diabetes Research Connection	Diabetes	$25k–$75k / 1yr	Closed (was Jul 2026)	Possible — target 2027	Co-funded NEI's AI+retinal pediatric diabetes study - strong precedent to cite
ADA Type 1 Diabetes RFA	Diabetes (T1D)	$138k/yr, $414k/3yr	TBD, check next cycle	Needs fit review	Bench/clinical T1D framing - unclear fit for a screening app
ASH Bridge Grant / ARCH Award	Anemia (hematology)	$150k, 1–3yr	Rolling	Needs fit review	ASH funds hematology science more than screening apps - frame around health equity/early detection
ASH Global Research Award	Anemia	Up to $150k / 3yr	TBD	Not now	Excludes US/Canada-based PIs
NCI ITCR / Imaging Data Commons	Cancer imaging	Program mechanism + free GCP credits	Rolling	Possible	No deadline - recurring informatics-tool funding line
DARPA Biological Technologies Office	Anemia (reframed as combat-casualty/triage screening)	Varies by award	Rolling abstracts through **Sep 30, 2026**	Possible	Best DoD fit is anemia (blood-loss/triage relevance); weak fit for diabetes/glaucoma consumer screening
ARPA-H (e.g. Delphi program)	Diabetes (non-invasive monitoring)	Varies by program	Program-specific	Possible	Likely what "ASBR" in the meeting notes meant- see Research Notes
CDMRP Vision Research Program	Glaucoma / vision	Up to ~$2.6M (FY26)	FY26: invite/LOI-only	Not now	Scoped to military-exposure-related vision injury, not general glaucoma; closed to new applicants this cycle

Data sources tracker

Source	Condition	Access	Status	Notes
AI-READI / FAIRhub	Diabetes	Public tier now; controlled tier by application	Available	~4,000 participants, multimodal incl. retinal imaging, NIH Bridge2AI-funded
EyePACS / APTOS 2019 / Messidor-2 / IDRiD	Diabetes	Free (Kaggle / IEEE DataPort)	Available	Standard diabetic retinopathy benchmarks
CP-AnemiC dataset	Anemia	Free (published dataset)	Available	710 labeled conjunctiva images; near-exact match to our product
Kaggle "Eye-Conjunctiva"	Anemia	Free	Available	Secondary anemia source
SMDG-19 / REFUGE / ORIGA / AIROGS	Glaucoma (imaging)	Free / request-based	Possible	Only relevant if glaucoma becomes an imaging product
TCIA	Cancer / MRI	Free (open tier); DUA via NCI CRDC/dbGaP (controlled tier)	Available (open) / In progress (controlled)	Post-Apr-2025 policy routes DUA-gated sets through CRDC, not TCIA directly
NCI Imaging Data Commons	Cancer / MRI	Free, cloud-hosted, AI-annotated	Available	Includes free GCP credits to experiment

Open questions / decisions needed

- [ ] **Mexico data collection:** flagged as a real ethics/compliance risk, not just a logistics question - see Research Notes.
- [ ] **Glaucoma product direction:** chatbot vs. future imaging screener determines which funding/data rows above matter.
- [ ] **DoD/ARPA-H strategic angle:** worth a deliberate go/no-go - see Research Notes

Next steps

- [ ] Fix and retest the glaucoma chatbot before any advertising push
- [ ] Pull AI-READI and CP-AnemiC data now: no funding or new IRB needed for either
- [ ] Draft NIH R21 specific aims around secondary analysis of AI-READI/EyePACS data ahead of the Oct 16, 2026 deadline
- [ ] Decide the glaucoma product direction with Dr. Penkova
- [ ] Revisit BrightFocus, Shaffer, DRC, and ADA for their 2027 cycles once preliminary results exist

Changelog

- **2026-09-16**: Initial tracker created from website review, NIH PAR-25-357 review, funding fact-check, and dataset research across diabetes/anemia/glaucoma/cancer. Added review of Dr. Penkova's papers and IRB checklist plus meeting-notes synthesis; live-tested the glaucoma chatbot (found broken); flagged the Mexico data-collection approach for ethics review.